5 LEVELS · 36 STEPS · FREE VS PRO MARKED

The Claude *setup kit*

A fill-in file about you, a starter skill, and every step with where to click. Checked on Anthropic's own help pages, 24 Oct 2026.



START HERE

5 levels, *36 steps*

Most people open Claude, type one message and stop. These are the steps that make it actually useful, in order. Start at Level 1: it's all free.

THE TAGS

FREE	works on the Free plan
PRO	needs Pro or higher
US ONLY	Claude Duet's waitlist, for now

In this kit

- **The about-me file**: fill it in once, Claude stops guessing.
- **The my-voice skill**: it writes like you, every time.
- **All 36 steps**, level by level, with where to click.
- **Instead of Duet**: a morning brief you can set up from India.

WHERE THE TIPS COME FROM

@artem.novitckii's "The art of Claude maxxing" carousel (24 Oct 2026). I rewrote them in plain words and checked every one. Menus move, so if one doesn't match your screen, search the setting's name in Settings.

PART 1

The *about-me* file

Fill in the brackets once. Claude reads it before every answer.

WHERE IT GOES

FREE	the Claude app: **Settings › Your Claude › Instructions**. Paste it there.
PRO	Claude Code or Cowork: save it as **CLAUDE.md** in `~/.claude/` (every project) or in one project folder. `/init` writes a starter, `/memory` edits it.

COPY THIS: THE ABOUT-ME FILE

```
# About me
Name: [your name]
What I do: [e.g. I make Instagram reels about AI tools for
Indian creators]
Who it's for: [your audience in one line]

# How I write
- Short sentences. Plain words. Talk like a friend, not a brand.
- [one more rule you always follow]
- Never use: [words you hate, e.g. "unlock", "game-changer"]

# How to work with me
- If the task is unclear, ask me one question first.
- When I ask for ideas, show me 3 options.
- Before a big change, tell me the plan.

# Examples of my best work
- [paste 2 real posts you're proud of]
```

PART 2

The *my-voice* skill

A skill is a saved how-to that Claude follows every time. This one writes in your voice.

1 Turn on file creation

Settings › Capabilities › Code execution and file creation (in the new layout: **Create and edit files**).

2 Make the folder

A folder called `my-voice` with the file below saved as `SKILL.md`, plus 3 of your own posts saved as `examples.md`.

3 Upload it

ZIP the folder (one skill per ZIP). **Customize › Skills › + › Create skill › Upload a skill.** In Claude Code (Pro): put it in `~/.claude/skills/my-voice/` and type `/my-voice`.

COPY THIS: SKILL.MD

```
---
name: my-voice
description: Writes or rewrites posts, captions and scripts in my
own voice. Use whenever I ask for content I'll publish.
---
# Write in my voice
1. Read examples.md first: 3 posts I wrote myself.
2. Match their sentence length, tone and the way they open.
3. Plain words. Nothing from my "never use" list.
4. Give me 3 different versions, then say which one you'd pick
and why.
5. Before you answer, check your draft against steps 2-4 and
fix it.
```

LEVEL 1

Give Claude *context*

Tell it about you once, so it stops guessing.

STEP · WHERE TO CLICK · PLAN	
SAVE A NOTE ABOUT WHO YOU ARE	The about-me file: Instructions (Free) or CLAUDE.md (Pro) · **Free**
SPEAK YOUR BRIEF	The mic icon in the message box. Hindi works too · **Free**
KEEP MEMORY ON	**Settings › Your Claude › Memory from chats** (on by default). Search and reference chats is Pro · **Free**
SHOW EXAMPLES	Paste one real example of what you want · **Free**
SEND A SCREENSHOT	**+** in the chat box › Add files or photos, or paste it · **Free**
A "HOW I WRITE" DOC	Upload it to a Project, or paste it into Instructions · **Free**
USE A PROJECT	claude.ai/projects › **+ New Project**, add files on the right. Free: up to 5 · **Free**

LEVEL 2

Teach Claude *skills*

A skill is a saved how-to it follows every time.

STEP · WHERE TO CLICK · PLAN	
WRITE A SKILL FILE	A folder with a `SKILL.md` : name and description on top, then the steps · **Free**
ONE SKILL PER TASK	Weekly report, email reply, invoice: one skill each · **Free**
FREE SKILLS FROM GITHUB	github.com/anthropics/skills (183k+ stars): download, ZIP, Upload a skill. Or Customize › Skills › **+** › Browse skills · **Free**
ADD EXAMPLE FILES	Templates and past work next to `SKILL.md` , named in it · **Free**
INSTALL PLUGINS	**Customize › Plugins › Discover › Add · Pro**
EDIT A SKILL	Open its files beside the chat, highlight › Edit with Claude · **Free**
START IT WITH /	Claude Code: `/` + the skill's name, e.g. `/weekly-report` . You make these · **Pro**

LEVEL 3

Let Claude *work alone*

Give it the whole job, not one message at a time.

STEP · WHERE TO CLICK · PLAN	
PLAN MODE FIRST	Claude Code: **Shift+Tab** until it says plan mode, or type `/plan` · **Pro**
CLAUDE CODE, NOT JUST CHAT	Desktop app › Code tab, or claude.ai/code. Not a coder? Hand the whole task to Cowork · **Pro**
SCHEDULED TASKS	**Scheduled** in the sidebar › New task, or "Every weekday at 8 AM..." in a chat › Schedule · **Pro**
HELPERS (SUBAGENTS)	Claude Code starts them itself, or `/agents` to make your own · **Pro**
AUTOMATIC CHECKS (HOOKS)	Claude Code: `/hooks` . A check runs every time, e.g. after each edit · **Pro**
LONG JOBS, LAPTOP CLOSED	A cloud session at claude.ai/code. Runs until done or your usage limit · **Pro**
CLAUDE DUET	claude.com/product/claude-duet › Join the waitlist. Pro and Max, checks in every few hours · **US only**
4 TASKS AT ONCE	Desktop app Code tab › **+ New** (Cmd/Ctrl+N). Each uses your limits · **Pro**

LEVEL 4

Connect your *apps*

Free connects 1 app and 1 custom connector. Pro connects as many as you need.

STEP · WHERE TO CLICK · PLAN	
GMAIL, NOTION, DRIVE	**Customize › Connectors › +** › pick one › Connect. In a chat: **+** › Connectors › on · **Pro** (Free: 1)
MORE APPS (MCP)	Customize › Connectors › **+** › add a custom connector (its server URL) · **Pro** (Free: 1)
CLAUDE IN CHROME	Chrome Web Store › Add to Chrome, sign in, pin it · **Pro**
THE DESKTOP APP	claude.com/download: Mac, Windows, Linux (beta) · **Free**
CANVA AND FIGMA	Customize › Connectors › Canva / Figma › Connect · **Pro** (Free: 1)
EVERY TOOL YOU USE	With 10 or more on: **+** › Connectors › Tool access › On demand · **Pro**
USE YOUR COMPUTER	Desktop app › **Settings › Capabilities › Computer use**. Beta; asks before each app · **Pro**

LEVEL 5

Make it sound *like you*

Good writing comes from steering, not one prompt.

STEP · WHERE TO CLICK · PLAN	
3 OPTIONS	"Give me 3 very different versions." · **Free**
CHECK ITS OWN DRAFT	"Check this against my rules and fix it before you show me." · **Free**
EXACT FEEDBACK	Not "make it better" but "Cut the intro. Open with the number. Max 3 lines." · **Free**
YOUR WRITING VOICE	The my-voice skill, or your rules in Instructions · **Free**
BAN OVERUSED WORDS	A "never use" line in the about-me file, plus what to do instead: "short, plain sentences" · **Free**
FINAL EDIT IS YOURS	Read it out loud once before you post · **Free**
A FOLDER OF POSTS YOU LIKE	Upload them to a Project (Free), or give Cowork the folder on your computer (Pro) · **Free**

FROM INDIA

Instead of Duet

Claude Duet is a US-only waitlist for now. On Pro you can get a morning brief today: connect Gmail and Google Calendar (Customize › Connectors), then paste this into a chat and click **Schedule**.

> COPY THIS: YOUR MORNING BRIEF
>
> ```
> Every weekday at 8 AM, read my new email and today's calendar.
> Send me the 3 things I should do first, and draft replies for
> anything urgent. Don't send anything.
> ```

Before you install anything

- **Official:** github.com/anthropics/skills, and plugins marked *Anthropic verified* in Customize › Plugins.
- **Community:** plugins like superpowers (by Jesse Vincent, github.com/obra/superpowers) are made by other people. Read a skill's `SKILL.md` before you upload it: it's plain text.
- Never paste passwords, API keys or bank details into a chat, a skill or the about-me file.



Start at Level 1. It's *all free*.

Every step checked on Anthropic's own help pages on 24 Oct 2026. Tips after @artem.novitckii's carousel.

— Abhay